Applying for WOSB/EDWOSB self-certify tips

Before you start: Check to see if you are eligible at https://certify.sba.gov/am-i-eligible

The process is fairly quick, once you've uploaded all of the documents. Because it's self-certify, upon approval, you will not receive a certificate. You will receive an expiration date of your status. Once you receive this expiration date, then you will need to go back into your SAM entity registration and update.

Do yourself a favor. If you do not have these documents already in PDF, then upload or save them in PDF. Having the ability to sign in Adobe will quicken the process.

Time of completion (in business hours/days): *From EIN to certification, it took me approx. 1 week*

- EIN/FEIN (to be received after you've incorporated your business) : Apply Now https://www.irs.gov/businesses/small-businesses-self-employed/how-to-apply-for-an-ein and Immediately receive your number, if there are no issues.

- DUNS (to be received after you've received your EIN/FEIN) : Approx. 24-48 hours (you will receive a notification email). https://iupdate.dnb.com/iUpdate/companylookup.htm

- SAM registration (if no issues): Approx. 3-4 days + MPIN will be set-up while you are registering for SAM. Also, you will have to wait approximately 24 hours after you are "ACTIVE" in SAM to register to self-certify. https://www.sam.gov/

- SBA self-certify: Time will depend on 3 things. 1) The amount of time it takes you to gather all of the necessary documents. 2) The amount of time to fill out the application. 3) The Approval process happens very quickly in less than 8 hours, upon submission. https://certify.sba.gov/

When you are approved, you should see an expiration date and decision for your WOSB and/or EDWOSB application. *Note: You must fill out a separate application for WOSB and EDWOSB. Your information will be stored from your first application, so you will not have to reupload documents nor re-answer questions that have been previously submitted.*

Application packages

Application package	Type	Program Participation Status	Submission Date	Expiration Date	Decision	Action
WOSB Self-Certification	Certificate	Active	00/00/2017	00/00/2017	Self Certified	

***Picture**: Example of self-certification completion page. You will not see anything in the "Action" column, unless you've been denied or an issue with your application.*

Women-Owned Small Business (WOSB) Preparation Checklist

Qualifying individual(s) include all women claiming 51% ownership

Active registration in the System for Award Management for the firm, available at SAM.gov (Note: The firm's DUNS number and EIN, and MPIN must exactly match SAM registration)

- ☐ Proof of U.S. citizenship (i.e., birth certificate, naturalization paper, or unexpired passport) for qualifying individual(s)
- ☐ Resume (optional) – *really isn't very optional, so tailor it for your govt. business*
- ☐ Joint Venture agreements (if applicable)

Choose one, according to your business structure:

- ☐ Corporation
  1) Articles of Incorporation
  2) Copies of stock certificates (front and back)
  3) Stock Ledger
  4) Corporate Bylaws and any amendments

- ☐ Limited Liability Company (LLC)
  1) Operating Agreement and any amendments
  2) Articles of Organization and any amendments

- ☐ Partnership
  1) Partnership Agreement and any amendments

- ☐ Sole Proprietor
  1) DBA (Doing Business As) or Trade Name Certificate

- ☐ Limited Liability Company (LLC)

  1) Operating Agreement and any amendments
  2) Articles of Organization/Certificate of Formation and any amendments

You will need both documents for LLC. If you do not, then use any of the hundreds of elaw sites or your business lawyer. I used https://formswift.com/ for my operating agreement (already had certificate of formation) that provides a 7-day free trial and $1.95 credit card charge upon signing up for the trial.

Reference: https://certify.sba.gov/prepare#wosb-anc

Economically Disadvantaged Women-Owned Small Business (EDWOSB) Preparation Checklist

Qualifying individual(s) include all women claiming 51% ownership and economic disadvantage

(in addition to all the things needed for WOSB, you need to have these extra items to qualify for EDWOSB)

- ☐ Personal Financial Information – Required for each woman claiming economic disadvantage and for each woman's spouse.*

  1) A completed and signed IRS Form 4506-T, Request for Tax Transcript
  2) Three most recent personal income tax returns (IRS Form 1040) including all schedules
  3) Three most recent W-2's
  4) Detailed information regarding the value of all assets (including cash on hand and in banks, accounts and notes receivable, retirement accounts, stocks, bonds, real estate, personal property, life insurance, and any other assets), liabilities (such as loans, mortgages, tax debts, and any other liabilities), and income (including salary, investment income, real estate income, and any other income) *FYI: This information will be in a questionnaire/input form on the site while you are applying, so you don't have to compile this info in a separate document.*

*Note: SBA may consider a spouse's financial situation in determining whether qualifying individual(s) are economically disadvantaged where the spouse has a role in the business (e.g., an officer, employee or director) or has lent money to, provided credit or financial support to, or guaranteed a loan of the business.

Reference: https://certify.sba.gov/prepare#wosb-anc